

DOORDASH

Platform Operations

Delivery Operations Analysis & Strategy

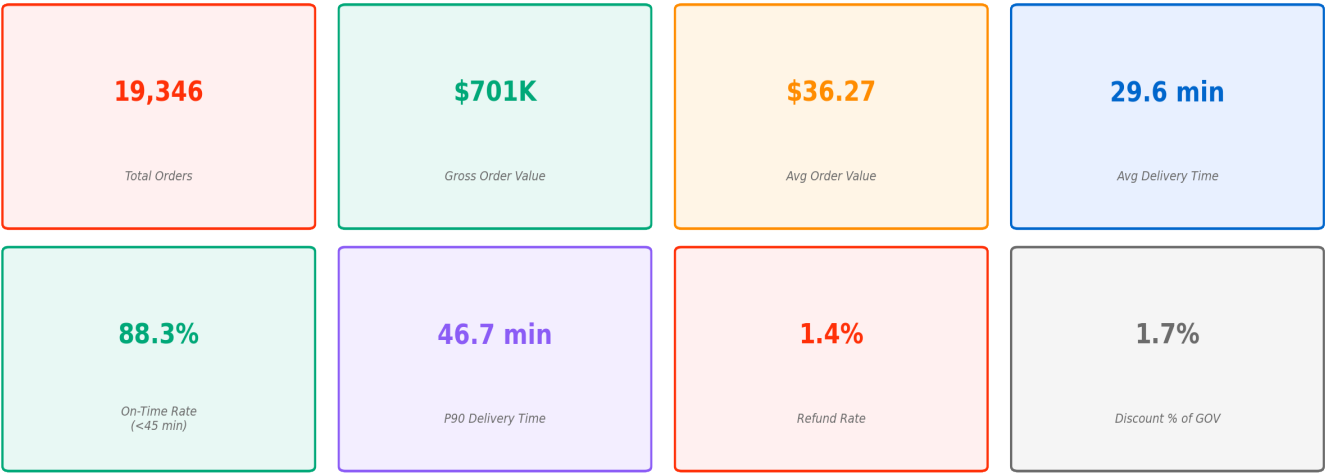
One month of delivery data across 56 markets — what it reveals about growth, efficiency, and where to act next.

19,346	\$701K	29.6 min	88.3%
Total Orders	Gross Order Value	Avg Delivery	On-Time Rate

Prepared by: Zarana Jodhani | September 2024 Dataset Analysis
Data Note: Times converted from UTC to Pacific Time (PT = UTC-7) throughout.

Executive Snapshot

September 2024 | 56 Markets | 19,346 Orders | \$701K Gross Order Value



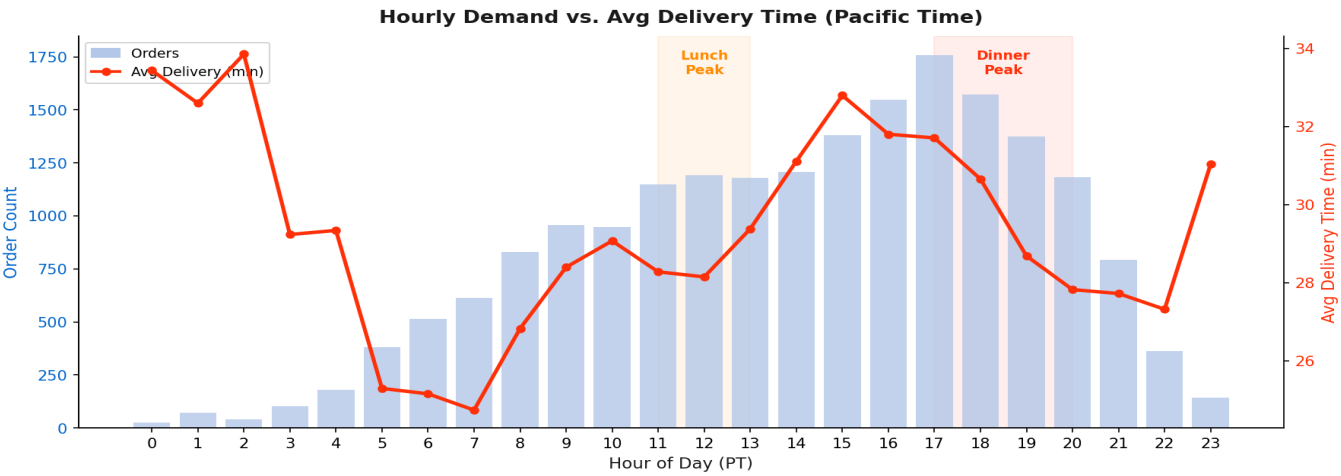
HEADLINE FINDINGS

#	Area	Finding	Signal
1	Speed	88.3% of orders delivered in <45 min; avg 29.6 min	Healthy baseline
2	Revenue	SF + Scranton = 29% of GOV despite being 2 of 56 markets	Concentration risk
3	Customers	76.2% are one-time buyers — massive retention gap	Biggest growth lever
4	Demand	Driver pickup wait (12.9 min) > Last mile (16.1 min)	Dasher supply issue
5	Discounts	Discounted orders have LOWER AOV (\$35.82 vs \$36.40)	Kill blanket discounts

Key Assumption: 'On-time' defined as total delivery <45 min, an industry-standard SLA. All timestamps converted from UTC to Pacific Time (PDT, UTC-7) to align with DoorDash's operating timezone.

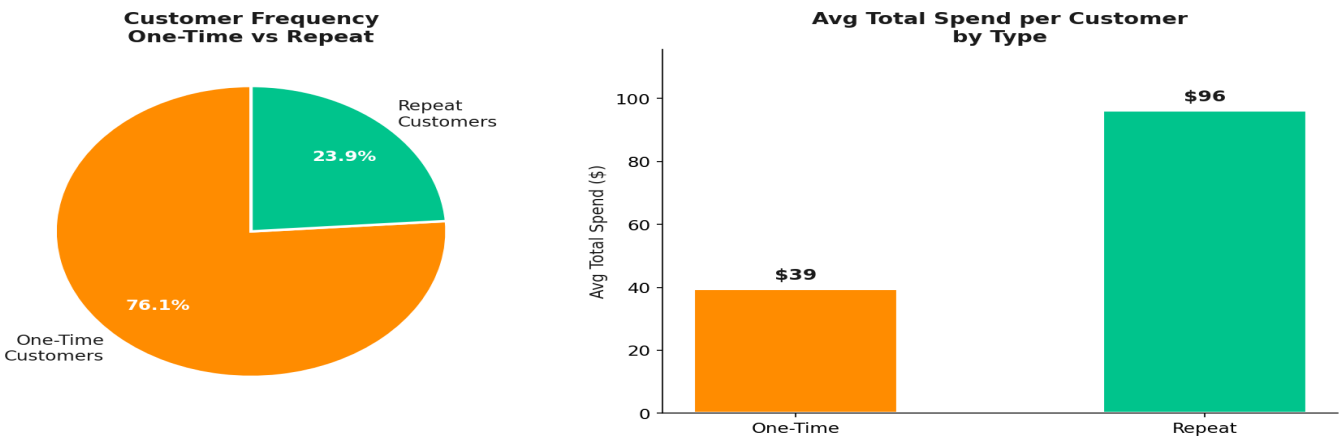
Demand Patterns & Customer Behavior

WHEN CUSTOMERS ORDER



Lunch Peak (11am–1pm PT) ~1,200 orders/hr. Delivery times are well-managed but this is a key stress window for the Dasher fleet.	Dinner Peak (5pm–8pm PT) Highest sustained volume (~1,600–1,750 orders/hr). Friday and Saturday dinner are the highest GOV windows.
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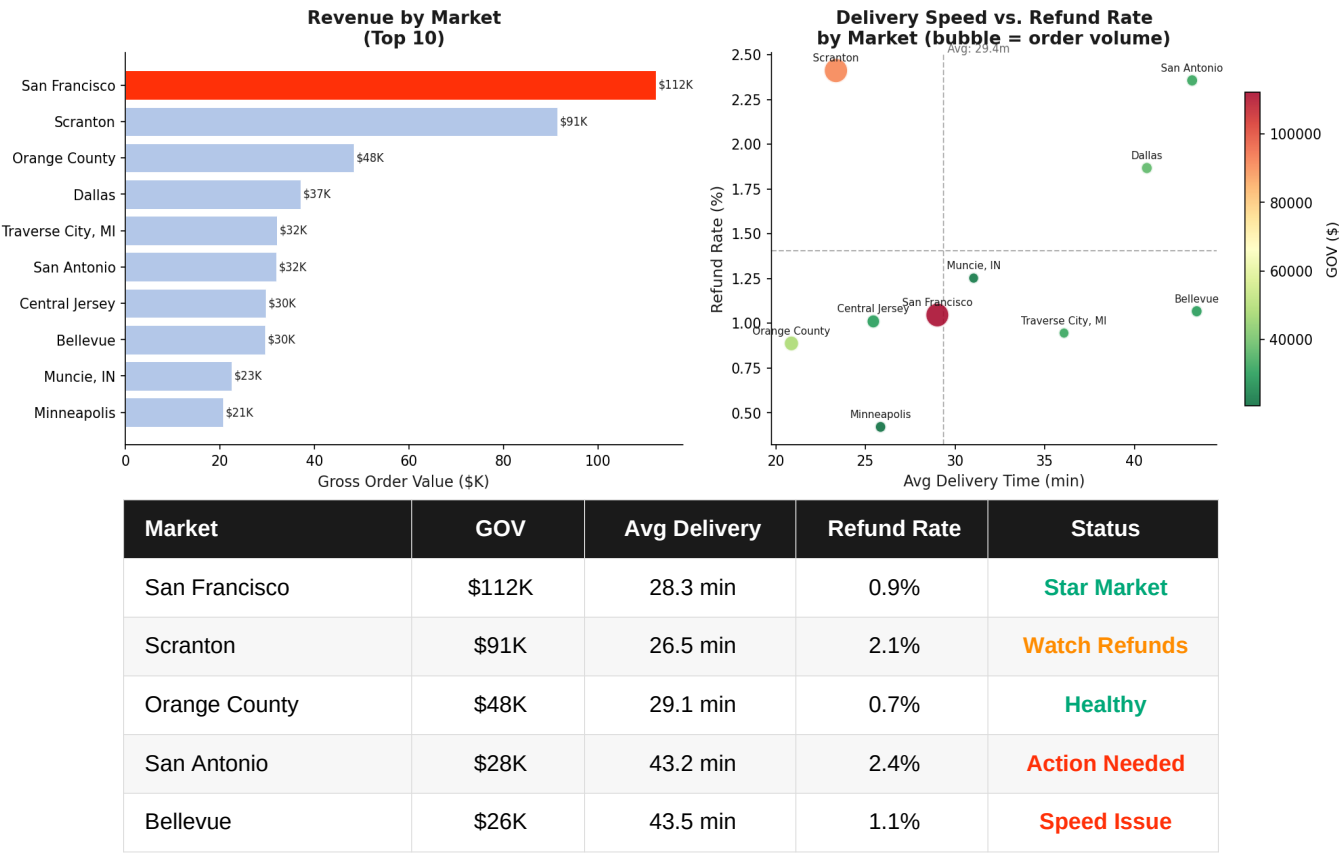
THE CUSTOMER RETENTION PROBLEM



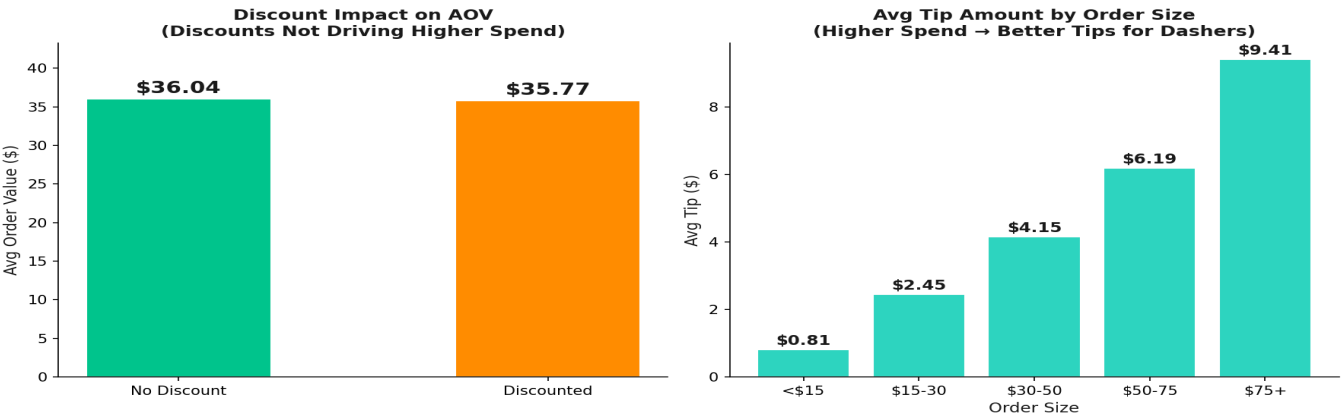
76.2% of customers ordered only once in the month — the business is too dependent on acquisition. Repeat customers spend 4.2x more on average, making retention the #1 revenue growth lever.	Implication: A 5-point shift from one-time to repeat (from 24% → 29% repeat rate) would add ~\$35K in incremental GOV without adding a single new customer.
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Regional Performance & Financial Levers

MARKET HEALTH: REVENUE, SPEED & QUALITY



FINANCIAL LEVERS — DISCOUNTS & TIPS



Discounts not driving incrementality. Discounted orders actually show *lower* AOV than non-discounted (\$35.82 vs \$36.40). This suggests discounts are being applied to inherently smaller orders, not converting customers to larger baskets.

Tip behavior is a Dasher supply signal. Customers spending \$75+ tip nearly 4x more than those under \$15 (\$9.57 vs \$0.86). Promoting higher-AOV merchants in peak hours increases Dasher earnings and supply availability.

Strategic Recommendations

Recommendations are organized across DoorDash's three-sided marketplace: Customer, Dasher, and Merchant. Each initiative is assigned an effort score (1=Easy, 10=Hard) and business impact score (1=Low, 10=High).

Priority	Initiative	Side	Effort	Impact	Time Horizon
#1	Repeat-Customer Retention Program Launch post-order re-engagement: push notification + 10% off 2nd order within 7 days for one-time customers.	Customer	6/10	9/10	30 days
#2	Peak-Hour Dasher Incentives Pay 15% surge bonus Fri/Sat 5–9pm PT. Driver pickup wait (12.9 min) is the biggest controllable delay — fix supply at peak.	Dasher	3/10	9/10	14 days
#3	Kill Blanket Discounts Replace with targeted loyalty discounts (order 3+, save \$3). Current discounts show negative AOV correlation.	Financial	2/10	7/10	14 days
#4	Regional Refund Audit (Scranton + San Antonio) High refund rates signal food quality or packing issues. Partner with top restaurants on SLA compliance.	Merchant	4/10	8/10	30 days
#5	Merchant Readiness Score Rate merchants on prep consistency; route peak-hour orders to high-prep-score merchants to reduce driver idle time.	Merchant	6/10	6/10	60 days
#6	Scheduled Order Expansion Scheduled orders have \$41.80 AOV vs \$35.85 for ASAP (+17%). Currently only 1.8% of volume — expand marketing push.	Customer	5/10	5/10	60 days

Priority Framework: Recommendations #1 and #2 are **Quick Wins** — high business impact, low implementation effort. They address DoorDash's two largest gaps: the 76% one-time customer rate and the Dasher supply bottleneck that drives late deliveries. Initiatives #3–#4 are operational improvements achievable within 30 days. #5–#6 are medium-term strategic bets.

90-Day Execution Roadmap

Immediate actions through strategic bets — structured for a three-sided marketplace.

WEEKS 1-2 Quick Wins	WEEKS 3-4 Foundation	WEEKS 5-8 Optimize	WEEKS 9-12 Scale
• Launch Fri/Sat Dasher surge pay (+15%) • Stop blanket discounts • Set up retention campaign A/B test	• Deploy re-engagement push (2nd order 10% off within 7 days) • Audit Scranton & San Antonio refunds	• Launch Merchant Readiness Score v1 • Expand Scheduled Order marketing • Review surge ROI	• Scale winning retention cohort • Extend Dasher incentive to Tues/Wed • Evaluate new markets

SUCCESS METRICS — 90-DAY TARGETS

Metric	Current	90-Day Target	Initiative Tied To
Repeat Customer Rate	23.8%	28%+ (+4 pts)	Retention Program (#1)
Peak-Hour On-Time Rate	~85% (est.)	90%+	Dasher Surge Pay (#2)
Discount % of GOV	1.7%	<1.0%	Kill Blanket Discounts (#3)
San Antonio Avg Delivery	43.2 min	<35 min	Merchant Readiness (#5)
Scheduled Order Share	1.8%	3.5%+	Scheduled Expansion (#6)

Final Note: The biggest unlock for DoorDash is not operational — it's customer retention. With 76% of customers ordering only once, even a modest improvement in repeat rate delivers outsized GOV impact without requiring geographic expansion or customer acquisition spend. Pair this with Dasher supply improvement at peak hours, and the platform's flywheel — better experience → more repeat orders → better Dasher earnings → more Dashers available → even better experience — accelerates.